Lobby Assistant
Standard Operating Procedures



April 2016

This standard operating procedure (SOP) will assist USPS® employees to perform the prescribed tasks and successfully assist customers in the lobby to prepare retail transactions.

Success comes when we do the following:

a. Fully understand the customers' mailing needs as they first enter the retail lobby.
b. Gather information and provide suggestions to fit the customer's needs.
c. Assist the customer in preparing retail transactions.
d. Demonstrate outstanding customer service.
e. Enhance the customer experience with knowledge and professionalism.

A lobby assistant is responsible for doing the following:

a. Ask questions to determine customer needs.
b. Provide forms, pamphlets, and information.
c. Show customers where to get supplies.
d. Assist customers with transactions.
e. Prepare customers for retail window transactions.
f. Identify self-service kiosk (SSK)–eligible transactions.
g. Direct customers to the SSK (if applicable).
h. Show customers where to place the SSK packages.
i. Identify mPOS-eligible transactions.
j. Complete mPOS-eligible transactions (if applicable).

In this SOP, you will learn the following:

a. How to effectively perform lobby assistance to reduce wait time and promote efficiency in conducting the retail transaction.
b. How to manage customers in line to prepare retail transactions and enhance the overall retail customer experience.

Overview

Customers who are fully prepared prior to reaching the retail window have more efficient, quicker transactions at the retail window than unprepared customers. This leads to all customers in the full service line experiencing a decrease wait time, enhancing the customer experience in the retail lobby. By having a lobby assistant prepare customers upon arrival in the retail lobby, the overall wait time will be reduced resulting in greater customer satisfaction and an exceptional customer experience.

Sales and service associates (SSAs) have the postal expertise required for successful lobby assistance. SSAs are able to efficiently answer USPS product and service questions and offer suggestions to meet customer needs. As a lobby assistant, SSAs will be performing SSA duties using postal knowledge in the lobby rather than behind a POS machine. The lobby assistant should be able to display self-initiative, perform with assertiveness, and be able to articulate the features and benefits of products and services to the customer.

Branding

Everywhere, every day, the United States Postal Service® touches every American. The USPS is a symbol of trust and dependability in the life of America. The Postal Service™ brand is much more than a logo or word. It's the sum of all the tangible and intangible characteristics in verbal and visual messaging that make our products and services unique to consumers. The brand is not only the image that we project but also how customers perceive the Postal Service. As America's oldest delivery entity, the Postal Service is trusted to deliver money, messages, and merchandise. Our competitive advantage depends on the way we do our jobs and our personality.

Lobby assistants are postal ambassadors, representing the brand and promoting USPS products and services. The lobby assistant should be neat and presentable and wear a full uniform that identifies them as a postal employee. A red lobby assistant vest may be worn by an SSA while working in the retail lobby as a lobby assistant. By using postal knowledge to engage the customer, the SSA can satisfy customer needs, increase customer satisfaction, and positively promote the USPS brand.

Lobby assistants should monitor the retail lobby to ensure it presents a clean, professional image to customers. Any down time should be used to straighten the lobby and replenish ReadyPost® and Expedited Package Service (EPS) supplies and forms. Debris should be removed from counters and writing tables.

Role of Lobby Assistant

The lobby assistant approaches, meets, and greets customers entering the retail lobby.

Lobby assistant responsibilities are the following:

a. Practicing good customer service — smile, be professional, and have a good attitude.

b. Using the "Greet, Inquire, Suggest, and Thank" (GIST) techniques when communicating with the customers.

c. Effectively assessing the customer's needs in the retail lobby to prepare retail window transactions.

d. Assisting the customer is the primary goal. While a pleasant greeting is necessary, the sole purpose of a lobby assistant is not to be a greeter.

e. Preparing customers for retail transaction. Although the lobby assistant is not behind the counter with a POS terminal, having SSA postal expertise is what makes the lobby assistant critical and valuable.

f. Monitoring the full-service line and redirecting customers with eligible transactions to mPOS or SSK.

g. Keeping postal forms, informational pamphlets, and shipping supplies replenished in the retail lobby. Also, keeping a 'tool kit' of the most used supplies on hand. Page 8 gives tool kit suggested items.

h. Answering questions from the customer. Providing feedback as requested (to customer and employee).

i. Getting to know your regular customers and coordinating with the manager any special needs (e.g., large mailers).

j. Being assertive and confident but not overly aggressive.

A lobby assistant is not a position but rather a role with duties within all SSA job descriptions. All window-trained employees should be instructed on the lobby assistant's role and use the mPOS and SSK (if applicable). All bargaining unit position hours worked as the lobby assistant are charged to LDC 45. The lobby assistant duties should be rotated among SSAs. It is preferable for a lead sales and service associate (LSSA) if available to oversee the lobby assistance duties.

To obtain proper credit for performing non-revenue transactions, maintain a checklist and provide input every half hour into POS. A sample checklist is included at the end of this SOP.

The goal is to approach *every* customer to prepare the retail transaction, reducing the number of unprepared customers who reach the retail window. Unprepared customers cause bottlenecks at the retail window and create long wait times for customers behind them. Prepared customers reduce transaction time which results in increased customer satisfaction and a better experience for all customers.



Objective: To engage customers entering the retail lobby to identify needs. To prepare customers for the retail transactions and reduce time spent at the retail window.

Engaging the Customer

Greet the customer. Smile and be pleasant, offer assistance by asking questions to determine the transaction. Offer suggestions based on SSA postal expertise.

For packages or mailings, do the following:

- Direct to the SSK if eligible (if applicable).
- Complete transaction on mPOS if eligible (if applicable).
- Make sure packages are addressed completely and packaged properly.
- Ask the required questions for the RCE survey to determine product and service needs, i.e., when do you need the package to arrive?
- Explain all products and services.
- Ask the HAZMAT question to determine if package contains anything liquid, fragile, perishable or potentially hazardous such as lithium batteries or perfume? Advise the customer a response will be required on the display unit at the retail window.
- Explain any required forms and assist the customer in completing all forms prior to reaching the retail window.
- Carry a tape measure and measure any large packages. Record the size dimensions on the package for the SSA at the retail window to input.
- If international, explain the international mailing process and customs forms and assist the customer in completing the required forms.
- Educate customers of the convenience of www.usps.com®. Tell them about completing customs forms, buying stamps, creating and printing shipping labels, and package pick-up.

All SSAs behind the retail window should be aware of the lobby assistant process. SSAs and lobby assistants should communicate on the types of codes or markings (such as initials or dimensions written on large packages) that will be used as an indication of a customer's preparedness to reduce redundancies in asking questions of the customer.

For other non-mailing transactions, take steps to prepare the customer prior to reaching the retail window. Some examples are the following:

a. Answer any questions or inquiries.

b. Handle pick-ups or hold mail according to local procedures to reduce SSA time away from the counter. For example, do the following:
    1. Complete delivery or acceptance of items on mPOS (if applicable).
    2. Carry a hand-held scanner to scan accountable pick-ups.
    3. Inquire of all customers in the lobby to see if anyone else has a pick-up to reduce multiple trips to retrieve items.

c. If a customer is dropping off packages with pre-paid postage, scan each package as "Accepted" with a hand-held scanner and stage the packages for dispatch. If the customer presents a PS Form 5630, or SCAN Form, verify the number of packages presented, scan the SCAN Form barcode, and return the form to the customer. Encourage customers with two or more pre-paid packages to use the SCAN Form.

d. For new PO Box™ rentals, explain PO Box fees and key policies, have customer complete application, and check identification.

e. If the customer is writing a check, validate the customer's identification.

f. For passport requests, explain the process and required documentation and give the customer the appropriate application.

Educate customers looking to purchase stamps on the types of stamps available at the retail counter and alternate locations for purchasing stamps, such as consignment locations, partner locations, or at *usps.com*.

Lobby Assistant 'Tool Kit'

Stock an apron, cart, or tray as a tool kit to be used by the lobby assistant. Having a tool kit will ensure that supplies are on hand to quickly assist the customers. Suggested items to include are the following:

Forms:

- *Signature Confirmation* (PS 153).
- *Insurance-Domestic $500 and Under* (PS 3813-Black).
- *Insurance-Domestic over $500* (PS 3818-P-Blue).
- *Certified Receipt* (PS 3800).
- *Return Receipt* (PS 3811).
- *Customs* (PS 2976, PS 2976-A).
- *Return Receipt for International Mail* (PS 2865).
- *Change of Address* (PS 3575) (if requested by customer).
- *Official Change/Correction to Mail Forwarding* (PS 3546).

Shipping Supplies:

- Priority Mail Express® and Priority Mail® Envelopes.
- Priority Mail Small Box.
- Stamped Envelopes.
- ReadyPost® Envelopes.
- ReadyPost Tape for Sale.

Applications:

- Passport Application (DS 11, DS 82).
- *PO Box Application* (PS 1093).

Miscellaneous Items:

- *Shipping International Packages* (PUB 613).
- *Special Requirements for Shipping Internationally* (PUB 699).
- *HAZMAT Information* (Notice 107).
- *Price List* (Notice 123).
- Priority Mail Stickers and Address Labels.
- Pencils, Pens, Highlighters.
- Tape.
- Tape measure.
- Scanner.
- Language Translator Guides (if needed by local community).
- List of Alternate Access locations within the community and hours.
- Apron or vest for identification and storage (if applicable).

Ancillary Duties for Lobby Assistants

Objective: To provide ancillary duties to be performed in the lobby by the lobby assistant during slow periods.

Lobby assistants shall be present in the lobby at all times the window is open. If customer traffic becomes slow, the lobby assistant remains in the lobby performing ancillary duties. The lobby assistant needs to be ready to assist in the lobby for arriving customers to create a positive customer experience.

Lobby assistants monitor the retail lobby to ensure it presents a clean, professional image to customers. They also remove debris from counters and writing tables.

Use any down time to straighten the lobby, replenish supplies and forms, and perform other tasks as needed, for example:

a. Some offices may have multiple EPS displays; monitor all displays to replenish inventory in the inner and outer lobby. Shipping supplies include, but are not limited to, the following:
    1. Priority Mail Express envelopes, Tyvek, and boxes (flat and variable rate).
    2. Priority Mail Express address labels and stickers.
    3. Priority Mail envelopes, Tyvek, and boxes (all sizes including flat and variable rate).
    4. Priority Mail address labels and stickers.

b. Replenish and straighten extra services forms and applications such as the following:
    1. Insurance.
    2. Certified Mail®.
    3. Signature Confirmation™.
    4. Registered Mail.
    5. Return Receipt (domestic and international).
    6. Certificate of Mailing.
    7. Customs forms.
    8. Passport forms, new and renewal (if applicable).

c. Restock and straighten retail merchandise, as needed. Retail merchandise includes, but is not limited to, the following:
        a. ReadyPost items; tape, bubble wrap, decorative boxes.
        b. Greeting Cards.
        c. Gift Cards.

d. Ensure proper POP signage is displayed and identify old or outdated signage. Check for display "up" and "down" dates in corner of signage. Notify the manager if required signage is damaged or needs replacement.

e. Visually inspect lobby and exterior area of Post Office™. Ensure the flag is in good condition and correctly hung, and notate any cosmetic or safety issues in the lobby to the site manager, such as loose displays or tables.

f. If a location or cart can be secured in the lobby, process second notices on accountable items when not assisting customers.

g. Keep a communications folder containing service talks, new products tip sheets, Retail Digest, and other material in the tool kit for review during down time.

h. If a site has a SSK, the lobby assistant must perform weekly maintenance and cleaning on the machine and replenish consumables.

i. Count the ReadyPost inventory in the lobby as audits are needed.

j. Place hang tags on vacant PO Boxes to advertise availability.

k. Monitor and empty the SSK collection drop to avoid overflows and jams. Perform an acceptance scan when applicable.

The last lobby assistant on duty when the retail window closes ensures that all supplies are well stocked for customers using the SSK after the window is closed.

On-the-Job Instructions for Lobby Assistance

Objective: Instruct employees on effective lobby assistance techniques to increase the comfort level on approaching and interacting with customers. Demonstrate how to identify SSK and mPOS transactions (if applicable) and prepare customers for retail counter transactions.

Prior to the on-the-job instructions, SSAs receive the lobby assistant module. For SSK sites, the servicing employee training is recommended.

When instructing employees how to offer effective lobby assistance, a trainer should show by example in a live lobby environment. The trainer demonstrates how to effectively approach and query customers while the SSA observes; then the trainer shadows the SSA while the SSA is performing the duties. The average time spent with each employee will be about an hour but this may depend on customer traffic.

During the on-the-job instruction, the district trainer (or designee) does the following:

a. Briefly explain the responsibilities and goals of the lobby assistant duties.

b. Take the lobby assistant through two to three SSK transactions to become familiar with the customer screens (if applicable).

c. Take the lobby assistant through two to three mPOS transactions to become familiar with the customer screens (if applicable).

d. Take the lobby assistant through several transactions in the live lobby environment to demonstrate greeting and inquiring techniques.

e. Shadow the lobby assistant for several transactions and ensure the SSA can effectively identify types of transactions and prepare customers.

f. Answer any questions.

Lobby assistants should be able to do the following:

a. Confidently approach customers upon arrival in the retail lobby.
b. Have a pleasant greeting and inquiry method.
c. Use slow periods for product replenishment.
d. Identify SSK and mPOS-eligible transactions (if applicable).
e. Direct customers to the SSK or full-service counter (if applicable).

f.

Lobby Assistance for SSK Sites

Objective: To engage customers entering the lobby to identify SSK-eligible transactions. Encourage customers to use the SSK.

In sites with a SSK, the lobby assistant monitors the retail line to identify transactions that are eligible for the SSK to redirect customers from the line to the SSK. The lobby assistant role is to introduce customers to the SSK, describe the functions available, and answer questions.

In offices with a SSK, the lobby assistant does the following:

a. Know what SSK transactions are available to the customer. Screen customers entering the lobby to identify eligible SSK transactions before they get in line.

b. Educate the customer on SSK capabilities and postal products and services. Explain the different mailing options and services provided by the SSK.

c. Explain the SSK accessibility functions. Identify the headphone jack for visually impaired customers.

d. Keep postal forms and shipping supplies replenished and located near the SSK.

e. Encourage the customer to conduct a transaction on the SSK. If the customer is reluctant, walk the customer through the transaction and operate the SSK.

f. If customers cannot be moved to the SSK, identify needs and assist customers prior to the retail window (i.e., forms completed, hold mail/mail pickups brought to the counter).

When available, lobby assistants should speak to each customer before entering the full service line to determine if the SSK can be used.

Smile, be pleasant, and offer assistance by asking questions to determine if the transaction is SSK eligible, for example:

a. "Do you have a debit or credit card that you can use for your business today?"

b. If the customer does not have anything in their hands, ask "do you need stamps?" Be sure the customer does not want to purchase a roll, explain the SSK will print FOREVER® stamps in any quantity.

c. "Are you mailing a domestic package or flat?" If so, this would be an SSK-eligible transaction.

d. "Are you sending the article Priority or Priority Mail Express?" If so, this would be a SSK-eligible transaction.

e. "Do you need insurance?" If so, this would be an SSK-eligible transaction; however, the customer can only purchase up to $5,000.00 in insurance at the SSK.

f. "Will you be adding any other special service to your mailing?"

g. "Is your package international?" Only international correspondence less than 16 ounces can be mailed at the SSK. If it requires a customs form, the transaction cannot be performed at the SSK. This includes APO/FPO mailings requiring a customs form.

h. PO Box renewal can be completed at the SSK.

If the transaction is not SSK eligible or the customer chooses to use the retail window, the lobby assistant assists the customer to prepare the transaction for the retail window.

Emphasize the availability of the SSK which is 24 hours per day, weekends, and holidays in the outer lobbies.

Note: Very Important: Before pulling a customer from the line, you must do the following:

a. Ask the customer if he or she can pay with a credit or debit card.

b. Make sure the transaction is an SSK-eligible transaction.

It is not necessary to walk the customer through the entire transaction. Direct the customer to the SSK and start the transaction. Let the customer do the rest. Only assist with the transaction if you see the customer struggling.

If necessary, make sure you show the customer the following:

a. Where the retail items are scanned on the SSK (if applicable).
b. Where their credit/debit card is swiped.
c. Where the postage labels or stamps are dispensed.
d. Where the large mailing labels (Standard Shipping labels (SSL)) are dispensed.
e. Where the customer receipt is dispensed.
f. Where to deposit the packages and other mail prepared on the SSK (in wall collection box, free-standing collection box, or Boise parcel slide).

Mention the the following benefits of using the SSK:

a. Minimizes time at the Post Office.
b. Eliminates or reduces time spent in line.
c. Provides English and Spanish language options.
d. Provides a receipt with information about their transaction including tracking numbers.
e. A lobby assistant is available to help or answer questions, as needed.
f. Provides 24/7 or extended access (where applicable).
g. Provides a headset jack and volume control buttons for customers to insert headphones to listen to audio directions on using the SSK.
h. Provides an easy access keypad for visually impaired customers. When using the EZ access keypad, the selected item is highlighted in red.

The lobby assistant monitors the SSK to ensure availability for customer transactions and does the following:

a. Provides timely responses to SSK alerts within 30 minutes.
b. Reports machine problems to manager to keep the SSK in working order at all times.
c. Performs a clean-up of the machine by wiping it down, and removing any dust and debris buildup. Follows the exact frequency and cleaning procedures in the SSK Cleaning Manual. Preventive maintenance prevents breakdowns.
d. Keeps the SSK area neat and clean. Makes certain there is an adequate supply of forms and Priority Mail Express/Priority Mail packaging placed in the EPS display adjacent to the SSK.

SSK FAQs

Note: Familiarizing yourself with customer frequently asked questions will be helpful.

Q. What does an SSK do?
A. Currently, 39% of all customer visits at the retail counter can be completed at the SSK. These actions include the following:

a. Weighs and rate letters, large envelopes, and packages up to 70 pounds.
b. Purchases postage stamps of variable rates through Print On Demand (POD).
c. Purchases domestic postage for Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, First-Class Mail®, and Retail Ground to ship letters, flats and packages.
d. Renews PO Box service.
e. Obtains information on prices, ZIP Code™ look up and mailing information.
f. Provides Track and Confirm look up for Priority Mail Express and delivery of items shipped using USPS tracking.
g. Purchases Special Services including Insurance and Certified Mail®.
h. Scans and purchases ReadyPost® packaging, greeting cards, and other retail merchandise, if the SSK has a scanner.
i. Sends international correspondence up to 16 ounces.
j. Provides English and Spanish language options.
k. Provides a receipt with information about the transaction, including tracking numbers.

Items that ***cannot*** be shipped on the SSK include the following:

a. Shipments to APO/FPO locations.
b. International merchandise and packages requiring a customs form.
c. Media Mail.
d. Signature Confirmation.
e. Money Orders (Domestic and International).
f. International Reply Coupons.
g. Registered Mail.

Q. Why will the SSK only accept international letters less than one pound?
A. Because international letters less than one pound do not require a customs form.

Q. Does SSK weigh and rate?
A. Yes, the SSK weighs and rates envelopes, flats, and parcels up to 70 pounds.

Q. Can you use the scale without completing a transaction?
A. Yes, you can initiate a weigh/rate transaction to weigh an item without completing the transaction.

Q. Does the SSK sell stamps only? Will the SSK vend actual stamps/coils/booklets?
A. The SSK dispenses First-Class Forever Print on Demand (POD) stamps in multiple quantities (minimum sale of $1.00) as well as postage strips in any denomination over $1.00 and postages strips for Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, and International. The SSK will not vend single stamps or coils.

Q. Is there a date on the postage strip?
A. Yes, the postage strip shows a "***Date of Sale***" and the postage amount.

Q. Will the SSK accept credit/debit only? What about cash?
A. The SSK is a cashless machine, payment via credit or debit cards only.

Q. Which credit cards are accepted?
A. All major credit cards including Visa, Master Card, American Express, and Discover.

Q. Will the customers need to enter credit/debit cards for every transaction?
A. Credit Cards:

1. The customer can purchase multiple items on one credit card dip.
2. Each credit card dip has a limit of $50.00, which is a pre-determined limit that has been set by the credit/debit process for self-service.
3. The daily limit for each credit card is $80.00.
4. If a customer's total visit exceeds $80.00, credit card payment is not offered as a choice, only debit. (If the customer does not want to pay with debit, he or she could cancel the transaction and purchase within multiple visits; multiple indicias would total to the amount needed to mail the article.).

B. Debit Cards:

1. There are no local/daily limits, only the amount of money that is in the customer's account.
2. The maximum single transaction is $134.95, and each mailing requires a separate "dip."

Q. Is there an SSK in every Post Office?
A. Not at this time.

Q. Can APO/FPO parcels be mailed from a SSK?
A. No. Parcels to APO/FPO addresses require customs forms and must be transacted at the retail window.

Collection and Processing of Articles From the SSK

Objective: To clarify the handling and processing of articles collected from the SSK due to lost DIM weight revenue or lost revenue opportunity.

All mail collected from both the inner and outer lobby SSK must be processed according to existing acceptance, processing, and dispatch procedures. Do as follows:

a. Look for oversize parcels, balloon-rate articles, and target mail (mail greater than 16 oz). If you see a customer mailing an oversize article, assist the customer with the transaction to ensure the proper surcharge has been applied. If the customer has completed the transaction, take the article and measure it (length and girth), and check the weight and rate. If the weight and rate are correct, dispatch the article as you would if it were accepted across the counter. If the weight and rate are incorrect, dispatch the article with postage due upon delivery. **Note:** Oversize articles are retail ground items with length and girth greater than 108" but less than 130".

b. If you see a customer mailing a balloon-size article, assist the customer with the transaction to ensure the proper surcharge has been applied. If the customer has completed the transaction, take the article and measure it (length and girth) and check the weight and rate. If the weight and rate are correct, dispatch the article as you would if it were accepted across the counter. If the weight and rate are incorrect, dispatch the article with postage due upon delivery. **Note:** Balloon Rate Articles are Priority Mail and Standard Post items that weigh less than 15 lbs. and have length and girth greater than 84" but less than 108". **Note:** A good practice is to always carry a measuring tape.

c. Scanning: Make certain that Expedited Service articles (i.e., Priority Mail Express, Global Express Mail, and Global Express Guaranteed Mail) receive the required acceptance scan by scanning them prior to dispatch. A good time to scan would be either immediately after sweeping the counter or during non-peak traffic times.

d. Acceptance scanning for pre-paid items can be performed on the handheld scanner.

e. Article Collection: Explain to the customer location of designated collection bin.

mPOS Lobby Process

In offices with the mPOS device, the lobby assistant does the following:

a. Actively engage customers to determine customer needs.
b. If there is a line for full service counters, the first priority is to engage customers in line to help shorten Wait Time in Line.
c. If there is no line for the full service counters, engage customers as they arrive in the lobby.
d. Redirect customers with eligible transactions that can be served by an SSK, if available.

Screen customers to identify if the customer has only the following eligible simple transactions that can be performed on the mPOS:

a. Stamp booklet sales.
b. Non-revenue mail pickup with a PS Form 3849.
c. Prepaid mail needing an acceptance scan (excluding customs and Priority Express items).
d. Priority Mail Flat-Rate postage sales.
e. ReadyPost or greeting card sales.

The customer must use a credit card or non-PIN debit card.

Safeguard the mPOS device and keep in the mPOS user's vest or clipped to belt during working hours. Safeguard mPOS stamp booklets, using the provided money belt or closed pouch.

If customers cannot be helped with the mPOS device or directed to the SSK, ask questions to prepare their transaction before they get in line for the full service counter, reducing the number of unprepared customers that reach the counter.

Always ask customers if there are other products they may be interested in purchasing, such as stamp booklets or shipping materials for future needs. The mobility of mPOS allows the lobby assistant to upsell products by introducing new items located throughout the retail lobby.

Smile and be pleasant, offer assistance by asking the following questions to determine if the transaction is mPOS eligible.

a. "Do you have a credit card that you can use for your business today?" If so, this could be an mPOS-eligible transaction if the entire mailing is mPOS eligible. Debit cards can be used if they can be scanned as a non-PIN transaction.

b. If the customer does not have anything in his or her hands, ask if she or he is purchasing stamps and if so, ask if the current mPOS booklets on hand are acceptable.

c. "Are those prepaid packages you would like to drop off for acceptance scans?" If so, this would be an mPOS-eligible transaction.

d. If the customer has a PS Form 3849 or PO Box notice in his or her hands, ask "Are you here to pick up mail?" If so, this may be an mPOS-eligible transaction, if non-revenue.

e. "Are you here to purchase mailing products or greeting cards?" If so, this would be an mPOS-eligible transaction.

f. If the customer is shipping using a Priority Mail Flat Rate box or envelope, postage can be purchased using the mPOS device.

If the customer indicates that only part of their visit includes an mPOS-eligible transaction (i.e., stamp booklet and PO Box rental), then allow the customer to conduct the entire transaction at the full-service counter or SSK (if applicable). Assist the next customer. Do not have the customer conduct split or multiple transactions.

If the transaction is not fully mPOS eligible or the customer chooses to use the full-service counter, the lobby assistant assists with ensuring the customer is prepared with proper packaging and forms to reduce the time spent at the counter.

Note: Very Important: Before diverting a customer from the full-service line, it is imperative that the mPOS user do the following:

a. Ask the customer if he or she can pay with a credit card or non-PIN debit card.
b. Ensure the entire transaction is mPOS eligible.

Product Sales on mPOS

An mPOS user should carry between 10 to 25 stamp booklets in a secure location, using the provided money belt or closed pouch and secured to the mPOS user. The stamps must not be able to fall out of a pocket/pouch when the user is bending over.

The mPOS user can scan the stamp booklets, ReadyPost, greeting card, and/or retail product (excluding AIC 092 Philatelic items) on the mPOS device, then total. The mPOS user swipes the credit card and enters the last 4 digits.

The device will only prompt for a signature if the total dollar amount is over $25. If so, the customer is prompted to sign on the device with a finger. The option is given if the customer chooses a hard copy receipt and/or to have an email receipt, both or neither.

The customer enters his or her email address if the soft copy option is chosen. The hard copy receipt will print out (if chosen) and is given to the customer.

Prepaid Mail Acceptance on mPOS

When a customer presents a prepaid article with online postage, the lobby assistant scans the item on mPOS as accepted. A receipt will be generated and is handed to the customer. Mark the package with a line through the postage with a yellow highlighter to indicate the package has been scanned as accepted to avoid duplicate scans. Place the package in the SSK parcel drop in the lobby or other designated secured location if lobby drop is unavailable. Packages scanned as accepted on the mPOS device do not need any other acceptance scan and can be dispatched accordingly.

For prepaid metered Priority Mail articles not generated online, the mPOS handler attaches a label 400 and scans the label 400 as accepted. A receipt will generate with the label 400 number which is given to the customer.

Priority Express Mail items cannot be accepted in mPOS due to the service commitment requirements. Direct these customers to the full service window.

Mail Pick-Up for mPOS

If a customer has received a PS Form 3849 notice for mail pick-up or a PO Box notice, determine if the article is non-revenue and does not require a cash transaction (i.e., postage due, COD).

The following mail pick-up items can be scanned as delivered using the mPOS:

a. Priority Mail Express.
b. Tracking numbers.
c. Insured.
d. Certified (requires customer to enter address).

Mail pick-up items that *cannot* be scanned on mPOS:

a. Collect on Delivery (COD).
b. Postage Due or BRM.
c. Business Reply Mail.
d. Registered.

The mPOS user retrieves the item or contacts someone in the back to retrieve (based on local policy). Once the item is retrieved, scan the item barcode. The customer must sign for accountable items on the mPOS device when the article is delivered. The customer prints and signs his or her first initial and last name. For Certified Mail articles, the customer's address is also required to be entered.

Priority Mail Flat Rate Postage

If a customer has a Priority Mail Flat Rate box or envelope that needs postage, the lobby assistant processes the article using the mPOS device. Inform the customer that Priority Mail includes automatic insurance up to $50 and tracking. Ask the customer if he or she needs additional insurance. If the customer does not want additional insurance, process on the mPOS if customer is using a credit card or non-PIN debit card. Direct customers desiring additional insurance to the SSK or full-service counter.

Once the postage is printed and applied, the lobby assistant deposits the mail in the inner lobby parcel drop or other locally designated secure location. The article is considered 'accepted' and should not be left unsecured in the lobby or returned to the customer. If the customer is not ready to mail the item, the postage will have to be voided, and placed on a PS Form 3533 to be turned in at the end of the shift.

Priority Mail Flat Rate postage is 'accepted' when printed and does not need to be scanned as accepted again.

Postage cannot be processed on mPOS for non-Flat Rate variable weight items. Likewise, postage for Flat Rate articles that need additional insurance or any other special service cannot be printed on the mPOS.

Print postage labels only for items that are ready to be mailed. Do not print postage for future use since an acceptance scan is generated in PTS when printed. The postage label printer can be mounted on a cart or counter within easy range for the mPOS handler. Do not leave the postage printer unsecured on a table in the lobby

In offices with the mPOS device, the mPOS user does the following:

a. Actively engage customers to determine customer needs.
b. If there is line for full service counters, the first priority is to engage customers in line to help shorten wait time in line.
c. If there is no line for the full service counters, engage customers as they arrive in the lobby.
d. Redirect customers with eligible transactions that can be served by a SSK, if available.

NON- REVENUE TRANSACTIONS

OFFICE NAME:

DATE:

Lobby Assistant Name	08:30	09:00	09:30	10:00	10:30	11:00	11:30	12:00	12:30
Non Automated Pickup									
Respond to CFS Issues									
Summon Supervisor at Customer Request									
Change of Address-Exempt from Fee									
Product/Services Rate Inquiries									
Employment Application Inquiry									
Voter Registration									
Give Local Directions									
Provide Philatelic Information or Catalog									
Accept Hold Mail Request Forms									
Request Passport Form									
Request Tax Form									
Accept Consumer Service Form									
Request/Submit Selective Service Form									
Supply P.O. Box Holder Name/Address									
Supply Permit Holder Name/Address									
Miscellaneous Forms									
Other									

Lobby Assistant Name	13:00	13:30	14:00	14:30	15:00	15:30	16:00	16:30	17:00	17:30
Respond to CFS Issues										
Summon Supervisor at Customer Request										
Change of Address-Exempt from Fee										
Product/Services Rate Inquiries										
Employment Application Inquiry										
Voter Registration										
Give Local Directions										
Provide Philatelic Information or Catalog										
Accept Hold Mail Request Forms										
Request Passport Form										
Request Tax Form										
Accept Consumer Service Form										
Request/Submit Selective Service Form										
Supply P.O. Box Holder Name/Address										
Supply Permit Holder Name/Address										
Miscellaneous Forms										
Other										